PassFrame
TUITION

The Lighthouse Keeper's Daughter

Year 4 — 11+ Lesson Worksheet (PassFrame Tuition)

Comprehension | Fiction

Extract — read it carefully before answering

Clara had grown up with the sea as her nearest neighbour. Her father kept the lighthouse on Raven's Point, and every evening she watched him climb the spiral stairs to light the great lamp before darkness swallowed the water whole.

That night, the storm arrived early. Rain hammered the windows like a thousand tiny fists, and the wind howled around the tower so fiercely that the whole building seemed to shiver. Clara's father had gone down to check the boat, leaving her alone at the top of the stairs.

Then, through the streaming glass, she saw it: a small light out on the black water, flashing weakly, then vanishing, then flashing again. A ship in trouble, with no one to guide it home.

Clara knew the rules — only the keeper was allowed to touch the lamp. But she also knew that by the time her father climbed back up, the ship might already be lost on the rocks. Her hands trembling, she turned the great wheel herself, and the beam swung out across the water like a long golden arm, pointing the ship safely away from the reef.

When her father finally returned, soaked through and breathless, he found Clara still at the wheel, her jaw set with determination. He said nothing about the rules that night — only wrapped her in a blanket and told her, quietly, that she had the makings of a fine lighthouse keeper.

Questions

20 min · 12 questions

1. Where did Clara live, and what was her father's job?

2. What did Clara see flashing out on the water during the storm?

3. Underline the sentence that tells you the storm was very loud.

4. Underline the simile that describes the sound of the rain.

5. What does “trembling” suggest about how Clara felt as she turned the wheel?

6. True or false: Clara was allowed to operate the lamp under the usual rules.

7. Why do you think Clara decided to break the rules and light the lamp herself?

8. What had Clara's father gone to check when the storm began?

9. In your own words, explain what the flashing light out at sea meant.

10. What does the phrase “pointing the ship safely away from the reef” tell you about the result of Clara's actions?

11. Why do you think her father “said nothing about the rules that night”?

12. Do you think Clara was right to break the rules? Explain your answer using evidence from the text.